HireX — Local Setup, Configuration & Troubleshooting

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Platform Version: HireX V0 / Local Developer Onboarding Guide
Target Audience: New Developers, QA Engineers, DevOps
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1. Prerequisites & System Requirements

Before starting local development, ensure the following are installed:

- **Node.js:** `v20.x` or higher (LTS recommended)
- **Package Manager:** `npm` (v10+)
- **Database:** PostgreSQL 15+ running locally on port 5432
- **Operating System:** Windows, macOS, or Linux

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2. Step-by-Step Local Environment Setup

2.1 Backend API Setup (`hirex-Backend`)

```
cd hirex-Backend

# 1. Install dependencies
npm install

# 2. Configure environment variables
# Copy .env.example to .env
cp .env.example .env

# 3. Apply database migrations
npx prisma migrate deploy

# 4. Seed initial multi-tenant test data
npx prisma db seed

# 5. Start the backend development server (Port: 3001)
npm run start:dev
```

2.2 Recruiter Portal Setup (`hirex-employer-frontend`)

```
cd hirex-employer-frontend

# 1. Install dependencies
npm install

# 2. Start the employer development server (Port: 3002)
npm run dev -- -p 3002
```

2.3 Candidate Portal Setup (`hirex-frontend`)

```
cd hirex-frontend

# 1. Install dependencies
npm install

# 2. Start the candidate development server (Port: 3000)
npm run dev -- -p 3000
```

2.4 Interviewer Portal Setup (`interviewer`)

```
cd interviewer

# 1. Install dependencies
npm install

# 2. Start the interviewer development server (Port: 3003)
npm run dev -- -p 3003
```

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3. Local Port & Service Allocation Map

Portal / Service	Directory	Local URL	Port
Candidate Portal	`hirex-frontend`	`http://localhost:3000`	3000
Backend REST API	`hirex-Backend`	`http://localhost:3001`	3001
Recruiter Dashboard	`hirex-employer-frontend`	`http://localhost:3002`	3002
Interviewer Workspace	`interviewer`	`http://localhost:3003`	3003

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4. Default Seeded Credentials

After running `npx prisma db seed`, the following pre-seeded test accounts are available:

Role	Portal Login URL	Test Email	Password	Pre-loaded Context
Recruiter Admin	`http://localhost:3002/login`	`recruiter@hirex.dev`	`Password123!`	HireX Demo Corp, 4 Open Jobs
Interviewer	`http://localhost:3003/login`	`rahul.sharma@hirex.dev`	`Password123!`	Principal Architect, Confirmed session
Candidate	`http://localhost:3000/login`	`rahul@hirex.dev`	`Password123!`	Senior Full Stack Engineer, Resume

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5. Troubleshooting Common Failure Modes

5.1 "ECONNREFUSED 127.0.0.1:5432"

- **Cause:** PostgreSQL service is not running locally.
- **Fix:** Start PostgreSQL service via your OS service manager (e.g. `services.msc` on Windows or `brew services start postgresql` on macOS). Verify credentials in `DATABASE_URL`.

5.2 "Prisma Schema Drift / Migration Warnings"

- **Rule: NEVER run** `npx prisma migrate reset` in an environment where you want to keep test data.
- **Fix:** Always run `npx prisma migrate deploy` to apply pending migrations incrementally.

5.3 Cookie Not Being Saved / Login Redirect Loop

- **Cause:** `COOKIE_DOMAIN` environment variable is set incorrectly.
- **Fix:** For local development (`localhost`), ensure `COOKIE_DOMAIN` is **commented out or empty** in `hirex-Backend/.env`. Leading dot domains (e.g. `.hire.zobay.in`) only work in deployed multi-subdomain environments.

5.4 Schedular / MeetX Video Links Show `https://meet.hirex.dev/join/mtg_...`

- **Cause:** `SCHEDULAR_API_KEY` is not set in `.env`.
- **Status:** This is the intended **mock development fallback**. If you wish to generate live Schedular video links, obtain a dev API key from the platform team and populate `SCHEDULAR_API_KEY`.

5.5 Port Conflicts (EADDRINUSE: 3000 / 3001 / 3002 / 3003)

- **Fix:** Check running Node processes (`Get-Process node` on Windows PowerShell or `killall node` on macOS/Linux) and terminate lingering development servers.